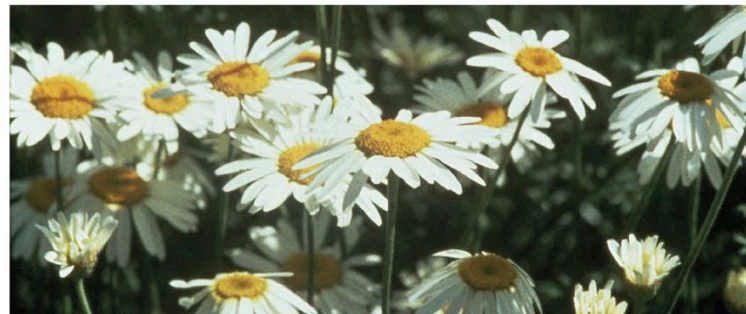


Summer flowers for containers

While relaxing on patios in summer, you observe containers more, so ensure that plants are in peak condition and provide season-long interest.

Annual bedding plants, such as geranium, petunia, and nemesia, are invaluable in pots, providing continuous color from early- to late summer. Maintain plants by keeping them well watered and removing faded blooms regularly, which stimulates plants to produce more flowers. As part of your summer display, include a few leafy specimens, such as hebe and hosta, to balance the flowery forms. If you include slow-release fertilizer granules when planting, you will not need to feed your plants again until late in the season, when they can be topped up with a liquid fertilizer.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Anthemis punctata subsp. cupaniana

SICILIAN CHAMOMILE This spreading evergreen perennial has silvery leaves and masses of daisy-like summer blooms. Plant in soil-based potting mix with annuals in mixed planters. Deadhead regularly.

±12in (30cm)

☀ Z6–9



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Brachyscome iberidifolia

SWAN RIVER DAISY Adding a decorative edge to pots and baskets, this bushy annual has feathery green leaves and blue, pink, purple, or white daisy-like flowers from summer to early fall. Plant it in potting soil.

±10in (25cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀



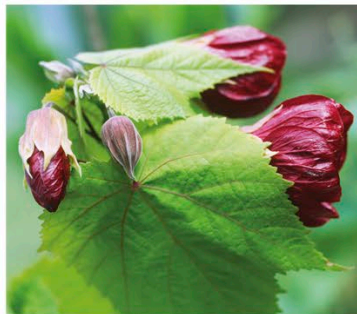
SHRUB LARGE

Brugmansia x candida

ANGELS' TRUMPETS Usually grown as a houseplant, this shrub has huge, trumpet-shaped, scented white, yellow, or pink blooms. Keep on a warm patio over summer in a container of soil-based potting mix. 'Grand Marnier' (above) has apricot blooms.

±15ft (5m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀ ☠ Z11



SHRUB LARGE

Abutilon 'Nabob'

FLOWERING MAPLE A tall evergreen shrub, grown as an annual, with maplelike foliage and bowl-shaped crimson summer flowers. Grow on a warm patio in soil-based potting mix; support with canes. To overwinter, take tip cuttings in late summer, or bring indoors.

±10ft (3m)

☀ Z9–10



PERENNIAL SMALL

Antirrhinum majus Luminaire Series

SNAPDRAGON Grown as an annual, this perennial has short spikes of lightly scented flowers in many colors. Let it weep over the sides of containers and baskets. Place pots away from strong winds; deadhead often.

±20in (50cm)

☀ Z9–11



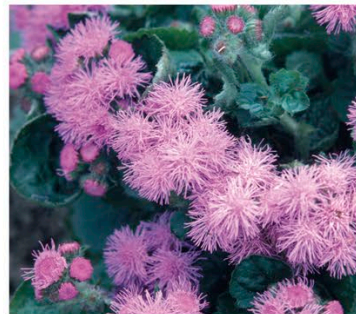
PERENNIAL SMALL

Calibrachoa Million Bells Series

MILLION BELLS This perennial, grown as an annual, bears pink, yellow, red, white, or blue trumpet-shaped flowers from summer to early fall. Use it for decorating containers. 'Cherry Pink' (above) is popular.

±12in (30cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z9–11



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Ageratum houstonianum

FLOSS FLOWER This compact annual has abundant fluffy pink, white, and blue flowers in summer, set against coarse dark green leaves. Grow in containers, hanging baskets, and windowboxes in potting soil. Deadhead regularly; water well.

±12in (30cm)

☀



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bidens ferulifolia

APACHE BEGGARTICKS Grown as an annual, this perennial has trailing stems of ferny green foliage and yellow star-shaped blooms that are perfect for edging tall pots or baskets from summer to fall. Plant with geranium or dwarf zinnias in potting soil.

±12in (30cm) ↔indefinite

☀ Z8–11 ☼



CLIMBER SMALL

Clematis SHIMMER

CLEMATIS This compact deciduous climber makes a beautiful patio feature, and bears large deep lilac blooms with a paler central bar on each petal throughout summer. Plant it in a large container of soil-based potting mix with a tripod support.

±6ft (1.8m)

☀ ☼ Z4–11